

Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory except that only one essay topic is to be attempted.
2. Write all answers in English and observe the indicated word limits.
3. Marks in this qualifying paper are not counted for merit ranking.

Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. Convenience without responsibility weakens citizenship.
2. Efficiency is not the same as effectiveness.
3. Certainty can be a barrier to learning.
4. Reading is an exercise in freedom.

Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

Public institutions often give greater attention to constructing a new asset than to maintaining an existing one. Construction creates a visible object and a date for inauguration; maintenance is repetitive, dispersed and difficult to celebrate. Yet the reliability of a road, school, irrigation channel or digital platform depends on regular inspection, repair and adaptation. Neglect rarely causes immediate collapse. A blocked drain, a small crack or an outdated software component first reduces the system's ability to absorb pressure. Under heavy rain, high demand or an emergency, minor weaknesses interact and create what appears to be a sudden failure. The problem is financial because capital and maintenance budgets are often separated. It is also institutional because responsibility may be divided among agencies, each expecting another to act. Users can supply early warnings, but their information matters only when complaints are acknowledged, assigned and followed by visible action. Good maintenance is therefore a form of public ethics: it respects money already spent, prevents avoidable harm and protects citizens who cannot purchase private alternatives.

1. Why does construction usually receive more public attention than maintenance?
2. Why may a supposedly sudden failure actually be the result of long neglect?
3. Identify one financial and one institutional cause of poor maintenance.
4. When does information supplied by users become useful?
5. Suggest a title and state the central argument.

Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Modern life rewards speed. Messages travel instantly, goods arrive rapidly and public opinion forms before facts have been fully examined. Speed can save lives and reduce costs, so every delay is easily treated as incompetence. Yet valuable work often needs time for attention, verification and judgment. A doctor may need to act quickly, but an incomplete diagnosis can expose a patient to needless treatment. A judge should avoid unnecessary procedure, but a decision made without hearing the parties is not efficient justice. Digital interfaces intensify the conflict by shortening the distance between impulse and action. Institutions should therefore distinguish delay from deliberation. Delay occurs when work is unattended or procedure serves no purpose; deliberation occurs when evidence is gathered, claims are compared and reasons are recorded. Measurement must also go beyond disposal counts, because workers may close cases without solving them when only speed is rewarded. Individuals need similar habits: verify before forwarding, pause before replying in anger and examine alternatives before an irreversible choice. The mature alternative to haste is not endless postponement but disciplined timeliness: acting as soon as necessary knowledge, authority and safeguards are present.

Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

A. Correct the sentences

1. One of the files are missing.
2. She is capable to solve the problem.
3. The officer discussed about the proposal.
4. Neither of the alternatives are acceptable.
5. I have been waiting since three hours.

B. Supply the missing preposition or word

1. comply ____
2. abstain ____
3. responsible ____
4. distinguish X ____
5. insist ____

C. Use the correct verb form

1. By the time we arrived, the meeting ____ (end).
2. If she ____ (work) regularly, she will improve.
3. The officer ____ (read) when the call came.
4. The Earth ____ (move) around the Sun.
5. He ____ (serve) here since 2022.

D. Choose the correct word

1. complement/compliment
2. stationary/stationery
3. principal/principle
4. affect/effect
5. discreet/discrete

END OF PAPER